REPUBLIC OF BOTSWANA

MINISTRY OF ENVIRONMENT AND TOURISM

Plant of the Month

June 2025



ALOE ZEBRINA Baker

Family: ASPHODELACEAE
Local Name: Kgophane / Kgope
Common Name: Variegated aloe / Zebra aloe

Description: It is a small, compact succulent aloe plant with distinctive spots on the leaves. Spots varies in sizes, shape and colour, mostly appearing green with whitish or greyish markings. Grows as single or form colonies through suckering. Has a fleshy succulent leaves with brown tipped teeth along margins. Flowers pale red, tubular form on a branched stalks, blooms in summer. Produces dehiscing capsule fruit with many small black seeds.

Growth habit: Grows on different types of soils. Able to tolerate arid to semi-arid conditions, grow on both sun and semi shade areas. It is widely distributed throughout Botswana and other Southern African countries.

Uses: Can be planted for decoration (ornamental purposes) or garden plant. Its roots are used to make dyes for weaving baskets or ropes. The leaves are used for medicinal purposes: cleaning the system for women after birth, disinfectant for wounds, human skin treatment and treatment of respiratory diseases on chickens.

OPENING HOURS
Monday to Friday 0730 - 1800hrs
Saturday and Sunday 0730 - 1800hrs
Public Holiday 0800 - 1800hrs

BOTSWANA national museum

national botanical garden

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